



HealthAtlas

Detailed User Manual Local Apple Health visualisation for macOS

English

Edition: Beta 1.6.0

Privacy-first local Apple Health visualisation for macOS

HealthAtlas - User Manual

Welcome

- HealthAtlas reads an Apple Health export that you choose locally on your Mac. You then decide exactly which recognised data types appear in the dashboard. The app does not diagnose conditions or recommend treatment.
- Every normal launch starts without imported health data.
 - Imported data stays in memory for the current session only. It is not uploaded or sent to an account.
 - Language, theme, card count and data-type selection are stored separately for the Dev, Beta and Final app variants.
 - While no personal data is loaded, the start screen also offers the matching GitHub manual and optional AI help. It copies only a general question with the public manual link to the clipboard; health values and local data stay in the app.
 - Requirement: macOS 26 or later.

Important

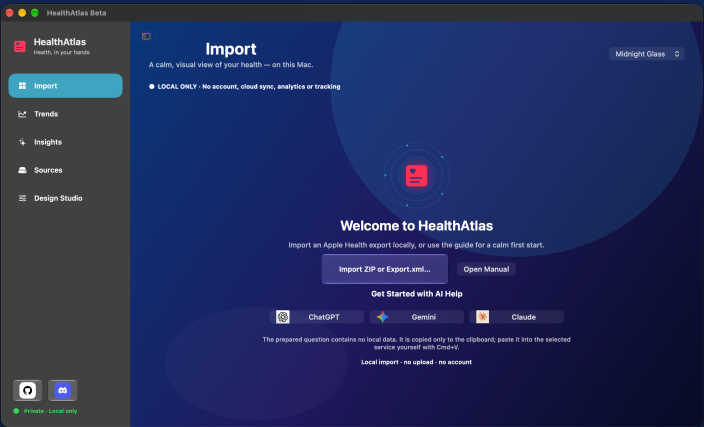
HealthAtlas describes values and trends. It is not a substitute for professional medical advice, examination or diagnosis.

Local only Imported values remain on this Mac while the current session is open.	Your choice Sources determines which data types are available across the app.	No diagnosis Charts and insights describe data; they do not rate it.
---	--	---

Quick start in 5 steps

The repository includes a fully synthetic demo export for a safe first test. It contains no personal health information and fictional values for every currently supported, non-deprecated Apple Health export type.

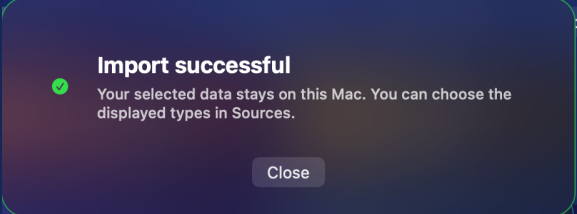
- Open HealthAtlas. The empty import view presents a central import button.
- Click "Import ZIP or Export.xml ...".
- Choose Demo/AppleHealthDemo/Export.xml or your own Apple Health export.
- Open Sources after import and turn the data types you want on or off.
- Explore the selected data in Overview, Trends and Insights.



Start safely

- The central import button opens a local file picker for ZIP or Export.xml only.
- The manual and optional AI help appear only before import. The prepared AI question contains no health values.

Empty start screen with a synthetic test interface. No health values are loaded before import.



Import complete

After a successful import, HealthAtlas confirms that the selected data stays on this Mac. Sources then leads to the selection of displayed data types.

Importing an Apple Health export

HealthAtlas accepts exactly two local formats: a direct Export.xml file or an Apple Health ZIP archive containing Export.xml. You do not need to unpack the ZIP first; HealthAtlas reads Export.xml locally from the archive.

- Direct Export.xml files and ZIP archives can each be up to 5 GiB. The contained Export.xml can also be up to 5 GiB after decompression. These are HealthAtlas safety limits, not Apple Health or macOS limits.
- Only one file can be selected at a time.
- During import, HealthAtlas shows the portion of XML bytes actually read. For ZIP archives, it uses the verified uncompressed size of Export.xml. The activity indicator remains visible during a phase without a reliably known total size. HealthAtlas does not estimate remaining time.
- HealthAtlas reads the original XML sequentially once. Only relevant interval values are processed further in a temporary local spool for the source rule. Fully identical exported records are counted only once.
- Reference measurement: On a Mac Studio M4 Max with 36 GB of RAM, importing a synthetic 500 MB file took about 41 seconds and a 1 GB file took about 1 minute 25 seconds.
- Estimated guidance: With similar file contents, near-linear scaling gives about 2:50 minutes for 2 GB, 4:15 minutes for 3 GB, 5:40 minutes for 4 GB and 7:05 minutes for 5 GB. Importing may take longer on other Macs depending on processor, SSD, file contents and current system load.
- Steps, distance and active energy use local 15-minute intervals to avoid adding overlapping sources twice. Discrete samples such as heart rate and body mass remain separate; sleep is likewise bounded per interval. Workouts are deduplicated only when their attributes match exactly.
- The export does not provide a reproducible Apple source-priority order. HealthAtlas therefore uses a fixed local rule and does not claim identical values to the Health app. Equal coverage uses a stable alphabetical source order that ignores case and diacritics.
- The clinical companion file in an Apple Health export is intentionally not imported.
- There is no direct HealthKit connection and no cloud import.
- For a wrong ZIP, unreadable XML or an oversized file, HealthAtlas explains the issue and imports nothing.
- For an import error, the message offers Copy Diagnostics for GitHub issue #13. The diagnostic contains only the app and macOS versions, input type, file size, import stage, error code, available XML line and column, and elapsed time. It excludes the file name, path, XML content, and health data.

Export on iPhone

In Apple Health, open Summary, tap your picture or initials, then select "Export All Health Data". Apple can change exact interface labels. Source: Apple Support, support.apple.com/en-in/guide/iphone/iph5ede58c3d/ios

Navigation and status

The frosted sidebar is visible by default in every theme. Before the first local import, its first entry is called "Import"; after a successful import it becomes "Overview". It shows "Private - Local only" at the bottom as a permanent privacy reminder.

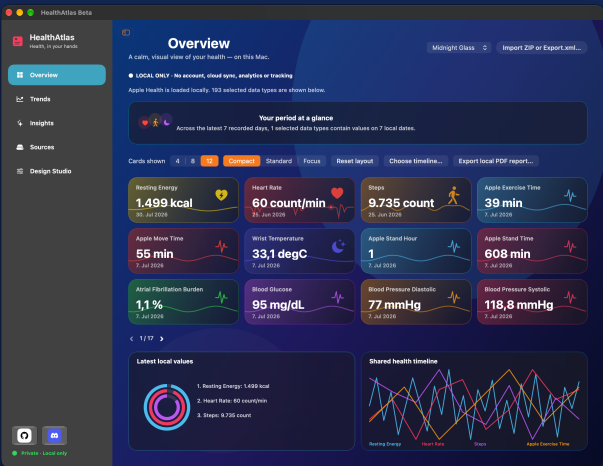
- Overview: cards for selected data types.
- Trends: an interactive timeline for one selected type.
- Sources: selection of all data types recognised in the import.

- Insights: a descriptive summary for one data type.
- Design Studio: language and appearance.
- The native menu bar provides import, the local PDF report, Design Studio and window controls. Use View to show or hide the sidebar.
- Interactive cards and charts are available as controls for macOS assistive technologies.
- The GitHub and Discord icons above the privacy status open the project page and community in the default browser.

Overview

After a successful import, Overview shows only the types enabled in Sources. Every card has a type-specific accent colour and graphic treatment. The displayed numbers use the most recent available daily value.

- Your period at a glance only describes how many enabled types contain values across the latest seven locally recorded days — never a goal, rating or diagnosis.
- Choose 4, 8 or 12 to control cards per page. Compact, Standard and Focus change card density locally. Drag and drop cards to reorder them; each layout saves its own order and can be reset.
- Previous and next controls appear when more selected types exist than fit on one page.
- Click a card to open a true full-screen focus view with a trend, period comparison and yearly calendar; Open Trends leads to the detailed view. Exit full screen returns to the app. Before a local PDF report, choose period, data types and report theme; it writes only to a location you choose.
- Use Choose timeline ... independently from cards, pins and Sources to select the one to four active types compared in the shared health timeline.
- Compact cards reserve a fixed text area for their title. The full Apple name for wrist temperature is shortened to Wrist Temperature there; Sources and detail views keep the full name.
- Below the cards, a shared multi-metric timeline and daily rings show recent local values from several types. Rings are neither goals nor ratings. At narrower window sizes, legends remain within their card.
- Steps, energy, distance and flights climbed are shown as daily sums. Other numeric types are shown as daily averages.
- Name, value, unit and date come from the selected export and follow the app language formatting.



New in Overview

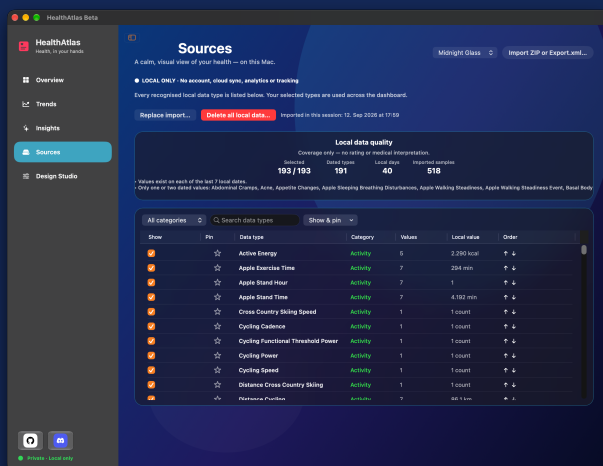
- Choose timeline opens a wide list and changes only the up-to-four lines in the shared timeline.
- The local PDF report has its own period, data-type and theme choices. Nothing is uploaded.
- Card count, density and order remain separate from the shared-timeline choice.

Overview with synthetic demo data. The shared timeline and local PDF report are configured independently.

Sources

Sources is the central selection area. It lists every recognised data type with an on/off switch, number of samples and a summary value. Category, search and Show & pin remain visible above the table. The table scrolls vertically when an export contains many types.

- Show & pin contains Show all, Show none and the Pin destination.
- The switch in each row immediately determines whether a type is available in Overview, Trends and Insights.
- Choose Pin for Overview, Trends or Insights from the menu. The star marks a favourite only for that area. Arrows set the order for the current dashboard layout.
- For a first personal import, the first four recognised types are selected by default. A compatible earlier selection is reused when its types occur in the new import.
- Local data quality counts selection, dated types, local days and samples. It also names missing days in the current local period and types with few values. It does not rate health data.
- Replace import opens the local file picker again. Delete all local data clears the current session only after confirmation. The visible import time applies only to the current session.



Selection and order

- Category, search and Show & pin remain visible above the table.
- The menu shows or hides all data types and selects the Pin destination.
- Local data quality describes coverage and imported values only.

Sources with synthetic demo data. This selection controls the content of all other areas.

Show all
Show none

Pin for Overview
Pin for Trends
Pin for Insights

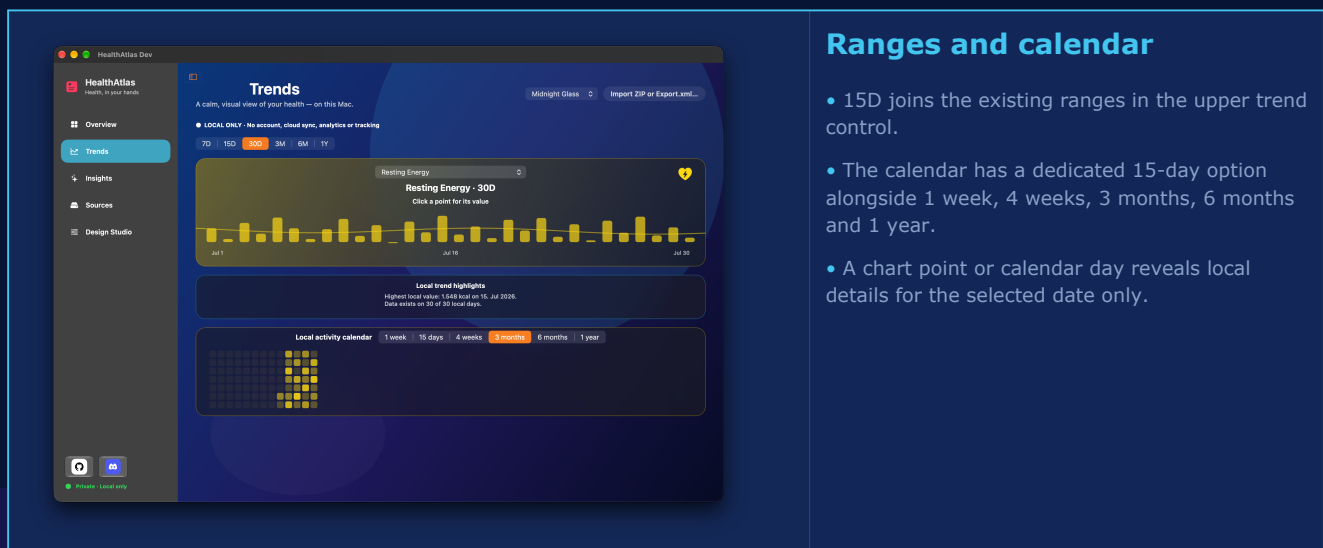
Show & pin

The menu contains Show all, Show none and Pin for Overview, Trends or Insights. The star in a row then sets the Pin for the selected area.

Trends

This section visualises one active type according to its local format: bars for steps and energy, an area for sleep, and a line for other numeric types. Select a period first, then choose one of the enabled types in the menu.

- 7D: last 7 days.
- 15D: last 15 days.
- 30D: last 30 days.
- 3M: last 90 days.
- 6M: last 182 days.
- 1Y: last 365 days.
- Hover a point to reveal a floating value card with date, formatted value and mini-trend. Clicking also gives that point a gently pulsing marker. Factual highlights can name the highest local value in the period or the number of dates with data.
- A local comparison places the current and immediately preceding periods side by side. It is not a rating or diagnosis.
- The local data calendar sits in a separate panel below the chart so day cells and line animation remain clearly separated. It offers 1 week, 15 days, 4 weeks, 3 months, 6 months or 1 year. Click a day to see its local date and value.
- If fewer than two values exist in the selected period, the chart reports that there are not enough values.

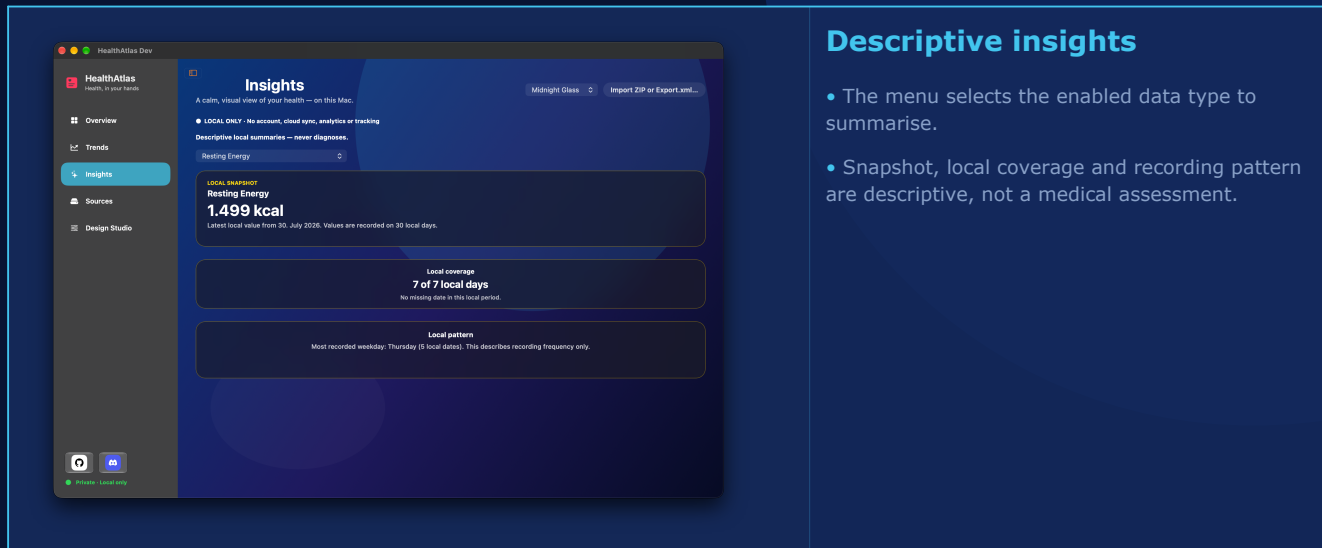


Trend with synthetic demo data. The 15-day period is available for both the trend and the data calendar.

Insights

Insights condenses one enabled data type into a local descriptive snapshot. Choose the type from the menu. The view shows the latest daily value, its date, local coverage and a recording pattern; it intentionally contains no detailed trend or data calendar.

- Local coverage only names days with and without a value in the current short period. The pattern names the most frequently recorded weekday. Neither is a rating.
- Local pattern only describes which weekday has the most locally recorded dates — not health or behaviour.
- The screen does not supply normal ranges, alerts, ratings or medical conclusions.
- If only one dated value is available, the app states this clearly.



Descriptive insights

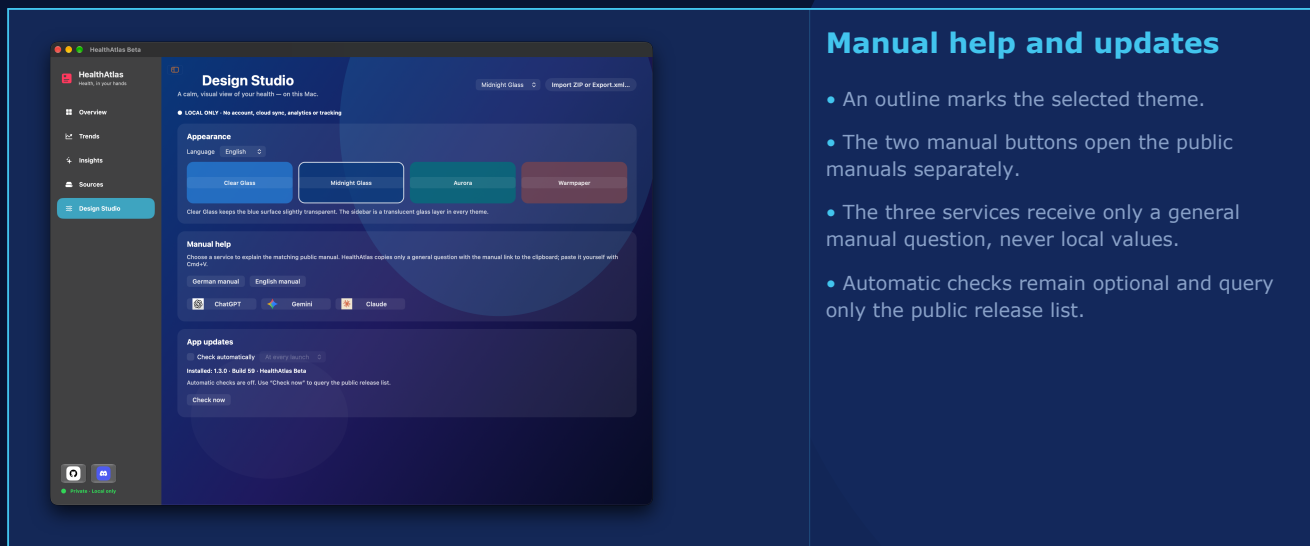
- The menu selects the enabled data type to summarise.
- Snapshot, local coverage and recording pattern are descriptive, not a medical assessment.

Insights with synthetic demo data. The card is a descriptive summary, not a diagnosis.

Design Studio

Design Studio groups Appearance, Manual help and App updates into three sections. Changes take effect immediately and are stored locally for the current app variant.

- Language: Deutsch or English. Navigation, labels and known data-type names change with the selection.
- Themes: Clear Glass combines a frosted layer with a calm cyan, blue, violet and pink glow; Midnight Glass is dark blue, Aurora teal and Warmpaper warm red-violet. Black & White uses neutral macOS materials, follows the light or dark system appearance, and retains coloured metric accents. The selected theme has an outline.
- Cards and pages use gentle transitions. Clear Glass and Black & White add very subtle motion, substantially reduced or paused with macOS Reduce Motion and while importing.
- HealthAtlas opens in 16:9 and remains freely resizable afterwards. The layout adapts to the selected window size.
- Under Manual help, German manual and English manual open the two public manuals separately.
- ChatGPT, Gemini and Claude copy only a general question with the matching public manual link to the clipboard after your click, then open the selected service. No local or imported health data is sent; only Cmd+V lets you decide whether to paste it.
- Under App updates, HealthAtlas shows the installed version and build number. Checking the public GitHub release list is optional: manually, at every launch, daily, weekly or monthly.
- An update check never sends health data. When a matching newer release is available, its GitHub page opens only after an explicit click.



Manual help and updates

- An outline marks the selected theme.
- The two manual buttons open the public manuals separately.
- The three services receive only a general manual question, never local values.
- Automatic checks remain optional and query only the public release list.

Design Studio with Appearance, Manual help and App updates. Manual help and the optional update check use public links only.



Black & White

- Black & White immediately follows the light or dark macOS appearance.
- Neutral surfaces stay readable while coloured metric accents preserve distinction in cards and charts.

The theme menu includes Black & White alongside the four existing themes.

Privacy and limits

HealthAtlas is designed as a local visualisation. It has no account, analytics, advertising, tracking or hidden upload. The app does not send imported health values to HealthAtlas, GitHub, Discord or another service.

- Data remains in memory while the app is open and is not loaded again at the next normal launch.
- GitHub and Discord are opened only by an explicit click on the lower sidebar icons. They receive no imported values.
- ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude open only after an explicit click on the empty start screen. Before that, HealthAtlas only copies a fixed general introduction question with the public, language-specific manual link to the clipboard. Only Cmd+V lets the person decide whether to paste the question into that service.
- The bundled demo is synthetic and allows feature testing without personal data.
- HealthAtlas is not medical software and not emergency assistance.

Symptoms or uncertainty

Please contact qualified healthcare professionals. A visual change in a chart is not a medical statement.

Troubleshooting and Gatekeeper

HealthAtlas is ad-hoc signed because the project has no Apple Developer account. macOS Gatekeeper may therefore warn when opening a Dev, Beta or Final build for the first time.

- Open the app normally once. macOS blocks the launch.
- Open System Settings > Privacy & Security, scroll to Security and choose "Open Anyway" for that exact HealthAtlas build.
- Confirm the warning with "Open" and authenticate if macOS asks. "Open Anyway" is shown only for a limited time after the blocked launch attempt.
- This creates an exception only for that build; do not disable Gatekeeper system-wide. Open only a build from the official HealthAtlas GitHub release.
- For import errors, confirm that the ZIP contains Export.xml, the file is not empty, is within the 5 GiB HealthAtlas limit and is stored locally.
- If the error remains, choose Copy Diagnostics and paste the text into GitHub issue #13. The copied text contains no health data or file-location details.
- If no values appear, enable at least one type in Sources. Trends need at least two daily values in the chosen period.

Build variants

Dev, Beta and Final use separate local preferences. A theme or selection in Dev does not alter the settings of a Beta or Final app.

Complete control reference

This table summarises every current area, control and outcome.

Area	Control	Outcome
Header	Theme menu	Changes appearance immediately.
Header	Import	Opens ZIP or Export.xml picker.
Menu bar	File / View / Window	Imports, exports the local PDF report, opens Design Studio, shows or hides the sidebar, and controls the window.
Overview	Period	Describes only local recording days.
Overview	4 / 8 / 12 · density	Sets card count and local card density.
Overview	Arrows	Moves through additional selected cards.
Overview	Card / PDF report	Opens the focus view or saves a local PDF report with its own choices.
Overview	Choose timeline	Independently selects up to four active types for the shared timeline.
Overview	Timeline / rings	Shows several local types; no goal or rating.

Area	Control	Outcome
Trends	7D / 15D / 30D / 3M / 6M / 1Y	Limits displayed days; the calendar offers 1 week to 1 year including 15 days.
Trends	Data type menu	Changes the displayed timeline.
Trends	Data point / hover	Highlights a point or shows date, value and mini-trend.
Sources	Row switch	Enables or removes one type.
Sources	Category / search	Filters the visible data types.
Sources	Show & pin	Shows or hides all types and selects the Pin destination.
Sources	Star / arrows	Pins a type for the selected area or orders it locally.
Insights	Data type menu	Changes the descriptive snapshot.
Design Studio	Language	Switches Deutsch and English.
Design Studio	Theme cards	Selects Clear Glass, Midnight Glass, Aurora, Warmpaper or Black & White.
Design Studio	Manual help	Opens the public manuals or prepares a general question for a chosen AI service; local values stay in HealthAtlas.
Design Studio	App updates	Shows version and build; optionally checks the public release list on the selected schedule.
Lower sidebar	GitHub / Discord	Opens the external project or community link in the browser.